

of millions of people. It is a landmark invention which ensures that, as long as you have a view of the sky above you, you will never be lost again.

Workshop: How to use a GPS receiver

Knowing how to use a GPS is as important as actually having one. If you are the type of person who is adventurous at heart but does not do many of the things that you long to because of the fear of getting lost, then a GPS would be your ideal solution. However, there are many small things to be kept in mind when you are operating a GPS receiver.

There are four basic functions provided by any GPS receiver: location, distance/direction info, route creation and tracking.

Finding a location

A GPS unit accurately triangulates your position by receiving data transmissions from multiple orbiting satellites. Your location is given in latitude and longitude.

Route navigation

A location or destination is called a "waypoint." For example, you can establish a starting waypoint at a trailhead by using the location function. All you need to do is to specify the

coordinates of the place that you want to go to (which will need to be taken from Google Earth or a book or something) and a GPS can give you a straight-line, point-to-point bearing and distance to your destination. However,

**Finding your way out
in unfamiliar terrain
is easy with a GPS
receiver along**

owing to the tendency of trails to never follow a straight path, the bearing changes as you go along. The indicated distance to travel will also decrease as you approach your goal.

Route creation

By combining multiple waypoints on a trail, you can move point-to-point with intermediate bearing and distance guides. Once you reach the first predetermined waypoint, the GPS receiver can automatically point you to the next one or you can manually do this.